MISSION BAY NEWS
Mobile Home Community

1971 *February 2026*

Shannon Howard
Administrator

Monthly Newsletter

Community Organizations

Mission Bay Men's & Women's Club
President
Nancy Garrett
nnny4@yahoo.com

Volunteer In-Park Emergency Unit
VIEU
Chairman
Peter Cleaveland
(510) 351-1742

Mission Bay News
Editor
Rube Domi
missionbaynews@gmail.com

Mission Bay Residents Association
MBRA
President
Deborah Acosta
mbhoasl@gmail.com
Assoc. Constitution posted in Clubhouse

Golden State Mobilehome Owners League
GSMOL - Chapter 518
Contact
Pat Bowens
(510) 357-7278

PARK SECURITY

If you see anyone who looks like they do not belong in the park, especially at an odd hour, CALL 911 FIRST

The San Leandro Police has advised us to leave our front and back porch light on all night.
NON-EMERGENCY number for the police dept. is (510) 577-2740

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Will you be my Valentine?

Mission Bay News Crew

Many thanks to our News Crew who organize and deliver our monthly magazine rain or shine! You are appreciated!

Alice Leung	Coordinator
Brenda Gianni	Activity Calendar
Vince Crabill	Distribution
Michael Garris	1 thru 33 | 501 thru 541
James Gamble	50 thru 72 | 150 thru 197
Vince Crabill	101 thru 145
Marta Barnes	201 thru 239
Rosita Gee	250 thru 289
Nancy Garrett	301 thru 338
Irene Zhong	350 thru 387
Darrin McWilliams	401 thru 440
Angie Chan	450 thru 491

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Sharron Kahoalii	7
Evelyn Lucero	9
Candance Griggs	9
Louise Pocengal	9
Kathy Enos	10
Ponchita Sheppard 1	4
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Michelle Richards	25
Lynda Ronguillo	27
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Kara Music	28

FEBRUARY *Anniversaries*

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ACTIVITY CALENDAR

FEBRUARY 2026



SUN.	MON.	TUES.	WED.	THURS.	FRI.	SAT.
1	2 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30 LINE DANCING 3 - 4	3 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	4 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEXICAN TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	5 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 CARD GAME 12 – 4:30 (Crafts Rm) CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	6 POKEENO 5 – 7:30	7 TAI CHI 10 – 11
8	9 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30 LINE DANCING 3 - 4	10 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	11 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEXICAN TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	12 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 BOOK CLUB 1 pm (Crafts Rm) CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	13 POKEENO 5 – 7:30 RECYCLE	14 MBRA MTG 10:00-11:00 
15	16 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30 LINE DANCING 3 – 4 	17 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4 	18 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEXICAN TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	19 TAI CHI 10-10:30 CARD GAME 12 – 4:30 (Crafts Rm) CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	20 POKEENO 5 – 7:30 BIBLE STUDY 6:30 pm (Crafts Rm)	21 TAI CHI 10 – 11
22	23 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30 LINE DANCING 3 – 4	24 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	25 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEXICAN TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	26 TAI CHI 10-10:30 CARD GAME 12 – 4:30 (Crafts Rm) CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	27 POKEENO 5 – 7:30 RECYCLE	28 TAI CHI 10 – 11



Gong Hei Faat Choi!

Meaning: Wishing you prosperity

The Lunar New Year starts on February 17, 2026, and ushers in the Year of the Horse! More specifically, it's the year of the Fire Horse, which only happens every 60 years.

This ancient calendar dates back to the 14th century BCE (whereas the Gregorian calendar was introduced in 1582). The Chinese lunisolar calendar shares some similarities with the Hebrew calendar, which is also lunisolar, and has influenced other East Asian calendars, such as those of Korea and Vietnam.

Because the Chinese calendar defines the lunar month containing the winter solstice as the 11th month, the Lunar New Year usually falls on the second new moon after the winter solstice.

Just like New Year according to the Gregorian calendar (January 1), Lunar New Year celebrations start on the night before the first day of the new year.

VIEU NEWS

BY PETER CLEAVELAND

Earthquake Swarm in San Ramon

Back in 2015 the California Milk Advisory Board (under the name Real California Milk) ran a commercial showing cows reacting to an earthquake, calling it a foot massage. (if you're interested, you can see it at https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_yveyh3usa8).

Well, the folks in San Ramon and Dublin got a taste of that in December, when a swarm of 90 quakes that had been going on since November — of which 80 were magnitude 2 or more (strong enough to feel) — reached a peak on December 21 with two that reached 3.9 and 4.0 respectively — strong enough for people to say "did you feel that?"

Not enough to do any damage, but maybe enough to make the cows happy.

It turns out that these harmless little swarms happen all the time around the state, but they just help remind us that California is geologically active.

Of course this is not to say that there are no significant threats. A magnitude 7.6 earthquake struck off the coast of Japan on December 8, triggering a 28-inch tsunami, injuring 47 people and damaging more than 2800 buildings.

That followed a 7.0 that struck northeast of Yakutat, Alaska on December 6, with no resulting tsunami. A potentially more scary event — the eruption of a volcano in the Pacific Northwest — has scientists worried about the impact on society. Of course, like many such events, no one knows if and when it will happen.

VIEU 新闻

圣拉蒙地区发生地震群。

早在 2015 年，加州牛奶咨询委员会（以“真正的加州牛奶 / Real California Milk” 的名义）曾推出一则广告，画面中奶牛对地震作出反应，并把地震称作“足底按摩”。（如果你感兴趣，可以在这里观看：https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_yveyh3usa8）

而在去年 12 月，圣拉蒙（San Ramon）和都柏林（Dublin）的居民也算是亲身体验了一把。从 11 月开始，当地持续发生了一次由 90 次地震组成的地震群，其中有 80 次震级达到 2 级或以上（人们能够感觉到）。这一地震群在 12 月 21 日达到高峰，当天发生了两次地震，震级分别为 3.9 级和 4.0 级——强到足以让人说一句：“你感觉到了吗？”

虽然不足以造成任何破坏，但也许足够让奶牛感到开心。

事实证明，这类无害的小规模地震群在全州各地经常发生，它们只是提醒我们，加州在地质上依然十分活跃。

当然，这并不是说不存在严重的威胁。12 月 8 日，日本近海发生了一次 7.6 级地震，引发了高达 28 英寸的海啸，造成 47 人受伤，并损坏了 2800 多栋建筑。

在此之前，12 月 6 日，阿拉斯加雅库塔特（Yakutat）东北方向发生了一次 7.0 级地震，但并未引发海啸。

而一个可能更加令人担忧的事件——太平洋西北地区火山喷发——正让科学家们对其对社会的影响感到不安。当然，和许多类似事件一样，没有人知道它是否会发生，以及何时发生。

COMMUNITY SAFETY BULLETIN



CALL FOR BLOCK CAPTAINS

We badly need some new block captains. If you would like to help keep your neighbors safe, please contact Pete Cleaveland at pcleaveland@earthlink.net, 510-351-1742, or by mail at 481 Santa Monica and we'll give you everything you need.

我们急需一些新的街区队长。

如果您愿意帮助保护邻居的安全，请联系 Pete Cleaveland，邮箱：pcleaveland@earthlink.net，电话：510-351-1742，或邮寄至 481 Santa Monica，我们将竭诚为您提供所需的一切。

Necesitamos urgentemente nuevos capitanes de cuadra. Si desea ayudar a mantener seguros a sus vecinos, por favor, contáctenos Pete Cleaveland at pcleaveland@earthlink.net, 510-351-1742, or by mail at 481 Santa Monica y te daremos todo lo que necesitas.

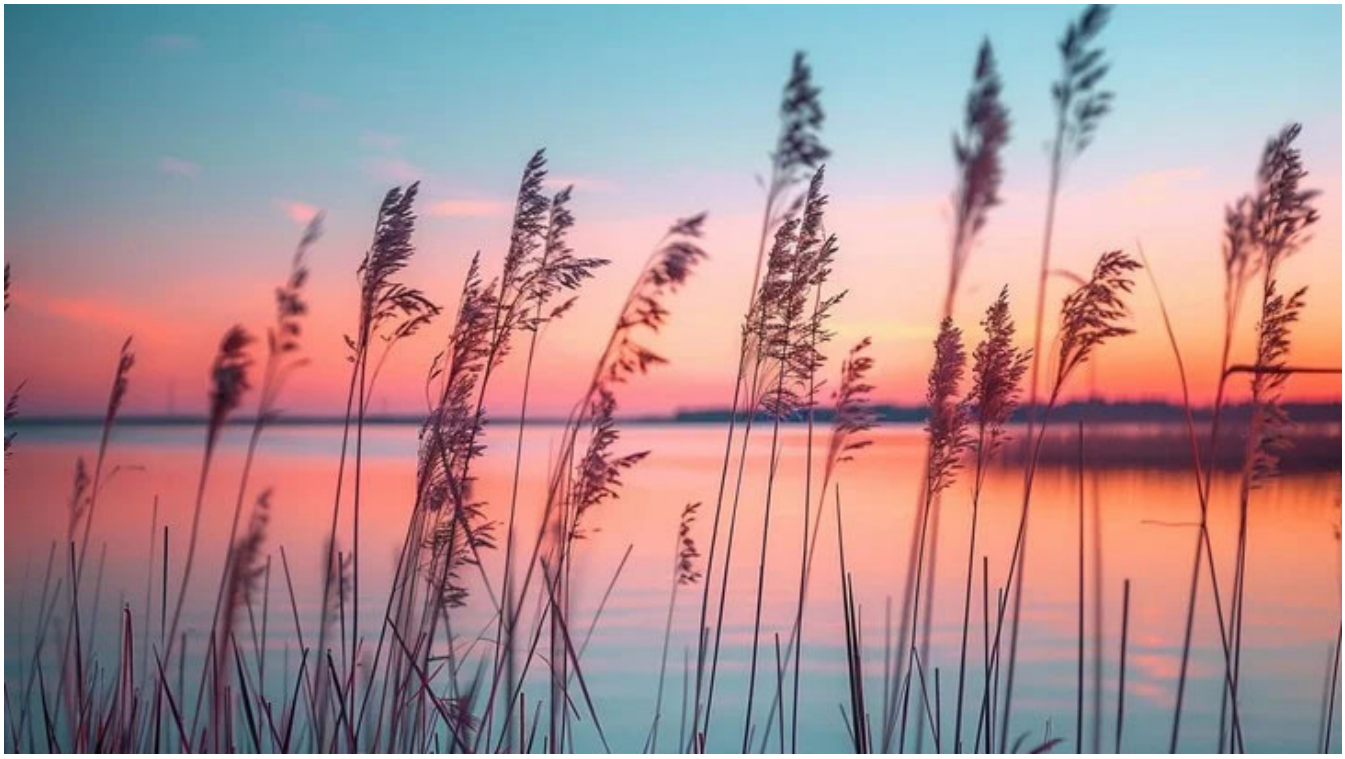
When disaster strikes—fire, earthquake, or other emergencies—every second counts. Our community needs trained, trusted volunteers to serve as Block Captains: neighbors who walk the block, check on residents, and help coordinate emergency response.

當災難來襲——火災、地震或其他緊急情況——分秒必爭。我們的社區需要訓練有素、⊠得信賴的志工擔任街區隊長：他們負責在街區巡邏，慰問居民，並協助協調緊急應變

Cuando ocurre un desastre (incendio, terremoto u otras emergencias), cada segundo cuenta. Nuestra comunidad necesita voluntarios capacitados y de confianza que sirvan como Capitanes de Barrio: vecinos que recorren la cuadra, se preocupan por los residentes y ayudan a coordinar la respuesta ante emergencias.

A BELATED SENTIMENT

In preparing this month's newsletter, I realized that a message meant the summer of 2025 did not make it into our publication. This was an oversight on my part while I was away, and I want to sincerely apologize for the delay. Joan's words of gratitude are still deeply meaningful, and I'm grateful for the chance to share them now.



"I wish to thank everyone for their flowers, cards and condolences for my friend, Sid Smith. Many thanks to my friends who took me to visit him at the rehab place over the four months for visits and playing cards. It meant alot to me and Sid. Your kindness and prayers won't be forgotten. He was a kind and gentle person, a card player and my partner for 25 years. His family and I thank you very much for your thoughtfulness.

Thank you also to those who have been helping get things done around my home. You are heroes!"

Sincerely,
Joan Cirillo

WORD SEARCH

The Rain Forest

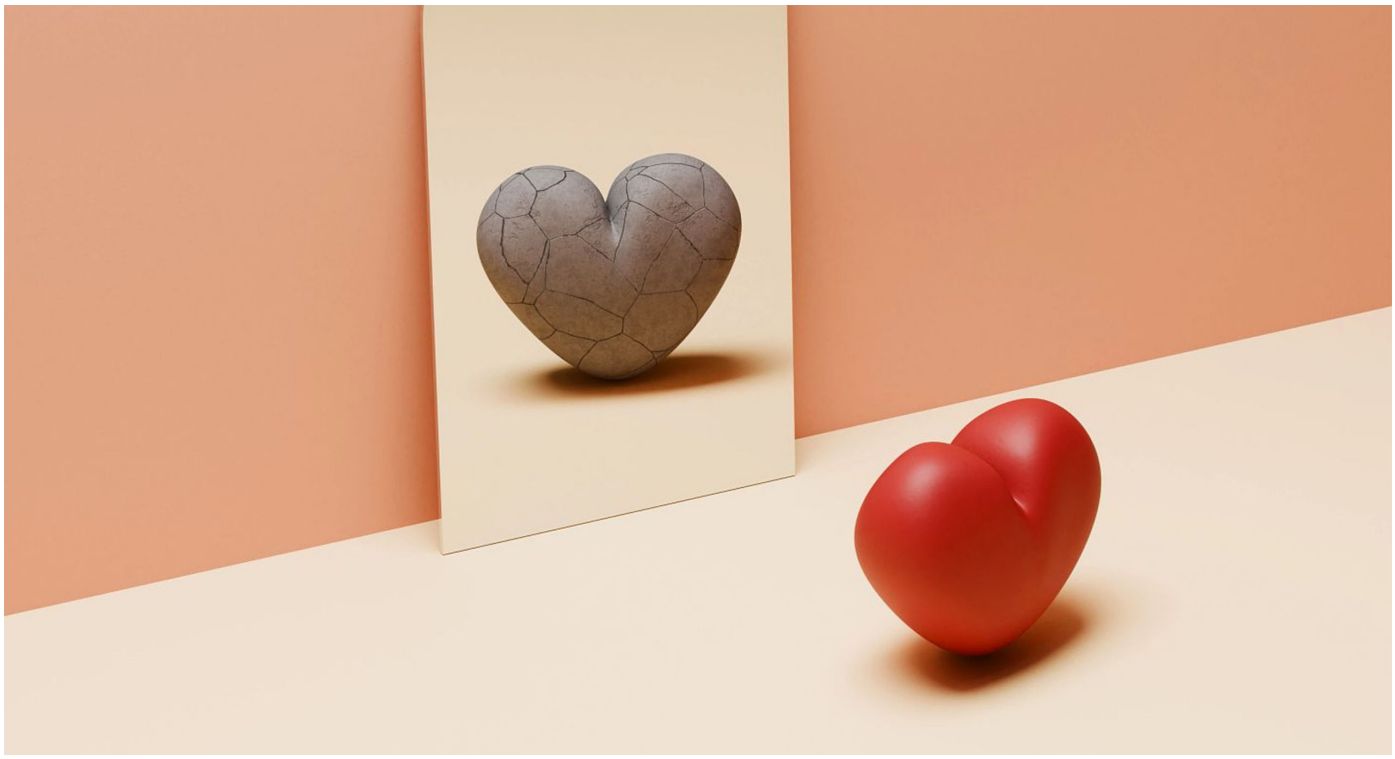
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S	W	A	C	A	M	O	H	A	S	L	O	T	H
H	Y	P	O	N	A	C	A	N	S	A	P	I	A
R	N	E	G	Y	X	O	T	G	M	R	A	E	G
U	D	R	A	I	N	A	E	P	L	S	T	N	A
B	O	T	N	K	N	X	E	I	F	R	O	G	S
L	C	O	O	A	O	Y	H	N	A	H	E	S	W
A	A	C	N	R	F	A	C	E	Y	G	L	R	A
Y	F	A	O	N	L	S	C	A	A	E	A	E	V
E	B	M	O	N	K	E	Y	P	P	U	V	W	O
R	F	I	G	G	A	R	R	P	A	P	R	O	C
G	N	K	O	A	A	R	C	L	P	A	E	L	A
G	O	R	I	L	L	A	N	E	N	V	A	F	D
A	M	A	N	G	O	O	T	O	U	C	A	N	O

OXYGEN
CHEETAH
ANTS
MACAW
TOUCAN
MONKEY
PINEAPPLE
GORILLA
BANANA
FLOWERS
FIG
PANTHER
SHRUB LAYER
RAIN
PAPAYA
FROGS
AVOCADO
MANGO
CANOPY
SLOTH

Play this puzzle online at : https://thewordsearch.com/puzzle/15945/

10 Worst Habits for Your Heart

By Jeanete Beebe , AARP



There's good news and bad news when it comes to your risk of developing heart disease, the leading killer in the U.S. Let's start with the bad. Several factors can raise your risk for getting heart disease — a term used to describe a range of conditions that affect the heart and blood vessels. Some you can't control, like family history, access to good-for-you foods and safe, affordable housing.

That said, there's a lot you can do to help prevent heart disease and, in certain cases, reverse it. Some of these actions, however difficult to achieve, are obvious: Get active, eat better, lose weight and stop smoking. "Lifestyle changes are difficult for everyone," says Dr. Sabra Lewsey, a cardiologist and assistant professor of medicine at Johns Hopkins Medicine. "But they are profoundly important and can make lifesaving gains in your health."

Others are more surprising.

Here are 10 habits to avoid to improve your heart health.

1. Not getting enough physical activity

Not moving enough, especially on a regular basis, is risky for your health. Studies have shown a strong association between inactivity and cognitive decline, and an increased risk of death. Fortunately, almost any sort of activity that raises your heart rate is a good place to start. It's important to move your body and elevate your heart rate for at least 150 minutes every week. You should throw in twice-weekly strength training sessions too, according to the Physical Activity Guidelines for Americans, established by the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services.

That may seem like a lot of exercise, but you don't need to do it all at once. As long as you get your heart rate up for 15 minutes or more at a time, it counts. Also, "activity" doesn't have to be a gym class or a bike ride. It could be gardening, shopping, walking the dog or cleaning.

"You don't have to go from doing nothing to running marathons," says Dr. Quentin Youmans, assistant professor of medicine at the Northwestern University Feinberg School of Medicine. "In fact, the biggest leap in benefit comes from doing nothing to doing something. Just start by dedicating yourself to doing some activity every day to get your body moving."

Take, for example, beginning with a 10-minute walk. A 2023 study published in the European Journal of Preventive Cardiology found that increasing your activity by 1,000 steps a day — or about 10 minutes of walking — was associated with a 15 percent reduction in dying from any cause; an increase in 500 steps was linked to a 7 percent reduction in dying from cardiovascular disease.

2. Drinking too much alcohol

"Not everyone recognizes the connection between heart health and alcohol," Youmans says. Drinking

too much alcohol can raise blood pressure, cause irregular heartbeats "and even have a direct toxic effect on the heart."

Overimbibing "can lead to heart failure or a weakening of the heart," says Dr. Amber Johnson, a cardiologist and assistant professor of medicine at University of Chicago Medicine.

How much is too much? The World Health Organization declared in 2023 that no amount of alcohol is safe.

For those who do drink alcohol, the recommended limits in the U.S. are one drink a day for women and two for men.

3. Skimping on sleep

Not getting seven (or eight or nine) hours of good sleep a night will slowly, but quite reliably, damage your health, including your heart. "Poor-quality sleep or untreated sleep apnea can lead to high blood pressure and affect heart health," Lewsey cautions. Lack of sleep has also been associated with diabetes and weight gain, which negatively affect heart health too.

Sleep apnea can "cause abnormal heart rhythms," Johnson says.

4. Eating foods bad for your heart

A diet full of processed foods, saturated fat, sodium and sugar can contribute to heart disease. Instead, opt for a heart-healthy diet of fruits, vegetables, lean protein, nuts and whole grains.

In a scientific statement published in the journal Circulation, an American Heart Association (AHA) committee ranked the DASH (Dietary Approaches to Stop Hypertension) diet at the top of the list of heart-healthy diets. This diet, designed to treat or prevent high blood pressure, is low in salt, added sugar, alcohol and processed foods, and rich in vegetables, fruits, whole grains and legumes.

Also ranking high for its heart-health benefits is the Mediterranean diet, which, like DASH, consists of mostly plants, limits meats and focuses on "good fats" such as walnuts, almonds, olive oil and avocados.

A few tips: Swap sodas for water — a lot of water. Watch out for processed, sugary and fried foods, and be mindful of what you eat and drink at restaurants.

"Avoiding [foods] high [in] sodium is really important," Johnson says. The AHA recommends that most adults consume fewer than 1,500 milligrams of sodium per day, with 2,300 mg as an upper limit. Yet the average American consumes more than 3,400 mg of sodium a day, the AHA says.

Pay attention to those numbers from your routine blood tests, too. Watch out for an excess of bad cholesterol (LDL) and/or triglycerides and not enough good cholesterol (HDL). Also, high blood sugar can damage your blood vessels. People with diabetes are twice as likely to develop heart disease, and they're more likely to experience heart failure.

Try not to "overindulge with food," Youmans warns. "We all love that slice of pizza or juicy hamburger, and in fact, occasionally, those foods can be OK. But when our diets consist of foods high in fats and sugars all the time, it starts to affect our heart health negatively."

5. Living a lonely life

It's so important to have friends and family to lean on. Unfortunately, that kind of support is not as common as you may think.

In 2023, 1 in 3 adults ages 50 to 80 reported feeling isolated in the past year, according to the University of Michigan National Poll on Healthy Aging. More than 1 in 3 older adults (37 percent) reported feeling a lack of companionship. These circumstances can be terrible for your health, including your heart. A 2023 advisory from the U.S. surgeon general explains that social isolation and loneliness are associated with a 29 percent increase in the risk of heart disease and a 32 percent increase in the risk of stroke. What's more, the report says the effect of social isolation on high blood pressure among older adults "is even greater than that of other major clinical risk factors, such as diabetes."

That's why it's crucial to find a group of people who will be there for you and make you feel fulfilled. Try to "seek community resources and support groups to help you with these lifestyle changes," Lewsey says, and work to "build a network of support" to help you along the way.

Vaccines and Heart Health

Vaccines don't just help fight off some pretty nasty illnesses. Research suggests they can also help protect your heart.

A study published in the AHA journal Stroke found that people who were hospitalized for a flu-like illness were 38 percent more likely than adults hospitalized for other reasons to have a stroke within a month of their hospitalization. Receiving a flu vaccine within the year before hospitalization lowered a person's stroke risk to 11 percent.

A study published in the journal Circulation found that people with heart failure who got an annual flu vaccine were 18 percent less likely to die from cardiovascular disease or any other cause than those who didn't get a flu shot.

A study presented at the American Stroke Association's International Stroke Conference in 2020 found that the shingles vaccine may reduce stroke risk by about 16 percent in older adults.

A study published in JAMA Network found that full vaccination against

COVID-19 was associated with a reduced risk of heart attack and ischemic stroke after a coronavirus infection.

Source: American Heart Association

6. Smoking tobacco

Whether you vape or smoke cigarettes or cigars, tobacco is terrible for your health. Secondhand tobacco smoke is, too. But what you may not realize is that tobacco doesn't just damage your lungs and cause cancer; it's also bad for your heart.

"Even in someone who has been a long-term smoker, there are immediate and long-lasting cardiovascular benefits of quitting smoking," Lewsey says.

Tobacco damages blood vessels and causes plaque buildup (atherosclerosis), which can trigger a heart attack, abnormal heart rhythms and, eventually, heart failure.

What can you do? "Set a quit date," Youmans says. "Let your friends and/or loved ones know so that they can hold you accountable, and use nicotine replacement or other medicines to help you quit with the help of your doctor."

You can find tips and other help on the CDC's website.

7. Minimizing your mental health

Managing stress is key to maintaining good health. If anxiety gets out of control, we're more likely to do things that are damaging. Stress raises your blood pressure. Find things you enjoy that will help you calm down and breathe better. For some people, it's meditating. Others enjoy hiking, cooking or playing board games with friends.

Can anxiety or panic attacks damage your heart? Not usually, but heartbreak might. The condition is commonly called broken heart syndrome, and it's "a type of heart failure," Johnson explains. "If you are under very intense stress, like if you are in a car crash or your loved one dies suddenly, that can cause a weakening of the heart," she says.

The solution is often medication (such as beta-blockers), plus a plan to manage stress in a healthy way.

8. Waiting to lose weight

Carrying around extra weight, especially around your waist, is bad for your heart.

Obesity is a risk factor for heart disease. Researchers have found that the heavier you are, the higher your risk is for heart disease — it's a so-called silent heart injury, even if you feel healthy, even if your numbers look good.

It's also true that being overweight can spike your cholesterol levels, blood sugar, triglycerides and blood pressure. All of these factors damage your heart and raise your risk for developing heart disease.

"One tip is to buy a scale, as knowledge is power, and this will help you keep track [of your weight]," Youmans suggests. "To help to move the scale in the right direction, remember that you need to burn more calories than you consume, so try getting more active and eating fewer calories."

You don't need to lose much to reap heart-health benefits: Losing 5 to 10 percent of your body weight can improve your blood pressure, cholesterol and blood sugar numbers.

9. Neglecting your teeth

Though a clear scientific link between dental hygiene and heart health hasn't been established, some researchers say there is an association between the two. That is, poor oral health can mean poor heart health. Gum disease is associated with heart disease, and bacterial infections and inflammation appear to play a part, too.

"Good dental health, with regular cleanings, is also important [for] overall heart health," Lewsey says.

Despite that benefit, half of people 65 and older didn't see a dentist in 2021, according to the American Dental Association.

10. Giving up too soon

Good heart health is often difficult to achieve and even harder to maintain — especially when everyone around you continues to do things you know aren't good for you.

"A lot of these health behaviors that we have found to be important vary from community to community or culture to culture," Johnson says. "Certain cultures may not eat the foods that are considered heart-healthy ... so there may be some disparities."

Above all, it's important not to give up. "Habit change is hard," Youmans says. "It can take some time to break them, particularly if they are enjoyable."

He adds, "Anything that is worth having takes time. Making a small change that you can sustain for a long period is much more important than a bigger change that may be harder to sustain."

Every day is an opportunity to get healthier, whether it's walking past the candy jar, meditating or taking the stairs. Make your lunch the night before instead of grabbing fast food. Set up a weekly social group. Get 15 more minutes of sleep. Do it again, again and again.

How to Survive Your First Heart Attack

By Beth Howard, AARP

When your heart is in danger, every second counts. Take these steps to identify the symptoms and make it to the hospital in time



Every 34 seconds, someone in the U.S. has a heart attack. Every 60 seconds, someone dies of one. What sufferers do — or don't do — in the critical first moments can be the difference between life and death.

Now cardiologists are turning to the next big challenge: helping the nearly 40 percent of heart attack victims who never make it to the hospital. Many of them — 120,000 a year — will die, largely because they didn't seek help in time.

"It's a huge problem and a major unrealized opportunity," says Steven E. Nissen, M.D., chairman of cardiovascular medicine at the Cleveland Clinic. "People will still sit at home and take antacids because they think it's indigestion, or say, 'This can't happen to me because I'm a woman.' "

Here's what you can do to increase your odds of surviving a heart attack.

STEP1

Recognize the (less typical) symptoms

Men and women with a type of heart disease called atherosclerosis have a buildup of fat and cholesterol, or plaque, in the arteries. A heart attack occurs when a piece of that plaque breaks off and forms a clot that blocks blood flow to the heart muscle. The classic signs are chest pain; pain or discomfort in one or both arms, the back, the shoulders, the neck or the stomach (above the belly button — pain here is sometimes mistaken for indigestion); and shortness of breath. Sweating, nausea and vomiting are also common.

Yet studies find that as many as a third of heart attack patients have no chest pain. These patients are more likely to be older, female or diabetic. In fact, "the older you are, the more likely you are to have atypical symptoms," Nissen says. Research shows that as people age, they don't always experience chest or arm pain, sweating, nausea and vomiting. Instead, they're more apt to experience confusion and labored breathing, and to faint.

That's because as the coronary artery closes, the heart starts pumping less blood through the body. "With the stiffer blood vessels that older people typically have, they don't get enough blood flow to the brain, and pass out," Nissen says. "They wake up on the floor with vague chest pressure."

In general, symptoms may come on gradually, be hard to pin down, and stop and then start again. It's not uncommon to feel unwell days or weeks earlier. According to new data from Linköping University in Sweden, published in the Journal of Cardiovascular Nursing, people ages 32 to 74 who had had a heart attack were more likely to have visited the doctor in the week prior to the event than those who hadn't.

That's why Harlan M. Krumholz, M.D., a cardiologist and health care researcher at the Yale University School of Medicine, says to stay alert even when you're simply not feeling yourself: "If something feels really different from what you've experienced in the past, don't ignore it."



If you are alone, ask yourself: If someone else had your symptoms, would you urge that person to call for help? If the answer is yes, call.

STEP 2

Get Off the Internet and call 911

You need to get to the hospital within an hour to ensure the best outcome. "Time is muscle," Nissen says. "The earlier we intervene, the less damage to the heart, the better the chance for survival and the better the quality of life. The people who develop heart failure are the ones who get there too late."

Yet studies show that people often deny what their bodies are telling them and delay making the call. Some people waste precious minutes looking up their symptoms online; others decide to call their primary care doctor for guidance.

Patients with chronic conditions such as diabetes or chronic obstructive pulmonary disease may assume that these other health problems are to blame for their discomfort. "They wait for their medications to take effect to see if it makes a difference," says Angelo Alonzo, a research scientist at the Yale University School of Nursing who has studied heart attacks for 40 years.

The way to get past these self-imposed roadblocks: Tell your spouse, your children or a neighbor what's going on. "Others will give you the encouragement to call for help or take over for you," Krumholz says. If you are alone, ask yourself: If someone else had your symptoms, would you urge that person to call for help? If the answer is yes, call.



A regular, uncoated aspirin (not a baby aspirin) thins the blood and interferes with blood clotting.

STEP 3

What to do while you're waiting

Before the emergency medical technicians (EMTs) arrive, chew and swallow a regular, uncoated 325-milligram aspirin (not a baby aspirin), which thins the blood and interferes with blood clotting. It probably won't stop a heart attack, but it may limit the damage.

If you are able, unlock the doors, then rest. "Call someone to come over and wait with you," Krumholz says, "or talk with someone on the phone until help arrives."

Don't drive yourself to the hospital or have someone drive you. Ambulances have defibrillators in case your heart stops, as well as clot-busting medications, so EMTs may be able to start treatment before you get to the hospital. "If something goes south, they can deal with it," Krumholz says. "Equally important, they smooth the path for you. If you come in the front door, [hospital personnel] haven't had time to prepare for your arrival and you may have to wait for the cath lab team to assemble."

EMTs will also know the best cardiac center to take you to, says Sharonne N. Hayes, M.D., founder of the Women's Heart Clinic at the Mayo Clinic in Rochester, Minn. "The nearest hospital may be five minutes away," she says, "but the one best equipped to open up your arteries may be 15 minutes away."



If having heart attack symptoms, you need to get to the hospital within an hour to ensure the best outcome.

STEP 4

Say the right things

When EMTs arrive, focus on describing your symptoms and any risk factors. Be prepared to tell people what medications you're on, or bring a list with you. "If someone is taking Viagra, we need to know," Krumholz says. Viagra and some other medications for erectile dysfunction cannot be taken with nitroglycerin, which is typically given during a heart attack, as the combination can trigger a potentially life-threatening reaction.

Some studies suggest that it's harder for EMTs to recognize heart attack symptoms in women because they are less likely to have classic symptoms such as chest pain. If EMTs don't zero in on your heart right away and you're concerned, it's OK to say, "I think I'm having a heart attack."

Some people believe that if you say you're having chest pain, you'll get faster attention. It's more important to be honest, Krumholz says. Still, if you're having chest pain, mention that symptom upfront.

STEP 5

Be assertive

Studies suggest that how you are perceived can make a difference in how you're treated. In research from the McGill University Health Centre in Montreal, men and women who were shy or reticent waited longer for treatment, says study author Roxanne Pelletier. Try to be assertive, and don't play down your symptoms. If you say, "Oh, it's probably just heartburn," your condition may not be taken as seriously.

There is no shame if your symptoms turn out to be a false alarm. "Don't worry about looking foolish or bothering people," Krumholz says. "To catch all heart attacks, we're going to have some people come in when there's nothing wrong."

New Heart Tests

Better tests for detecting a heart attack in progress or for screening for future risk are in the pipeline.

A test with higher sensitivity
Scottish researchers have come up with a blood test that can detect far lower levels of troponin — a protein released when heart muscle is damaged — than those currently available. In a study published in the Lancet, the test identified low troponin levels in about two-thirds of people who were hospitalized with symptoms, indicating they were at such low risk for a heart attack that they were eligible for an earlier hospital discharge.

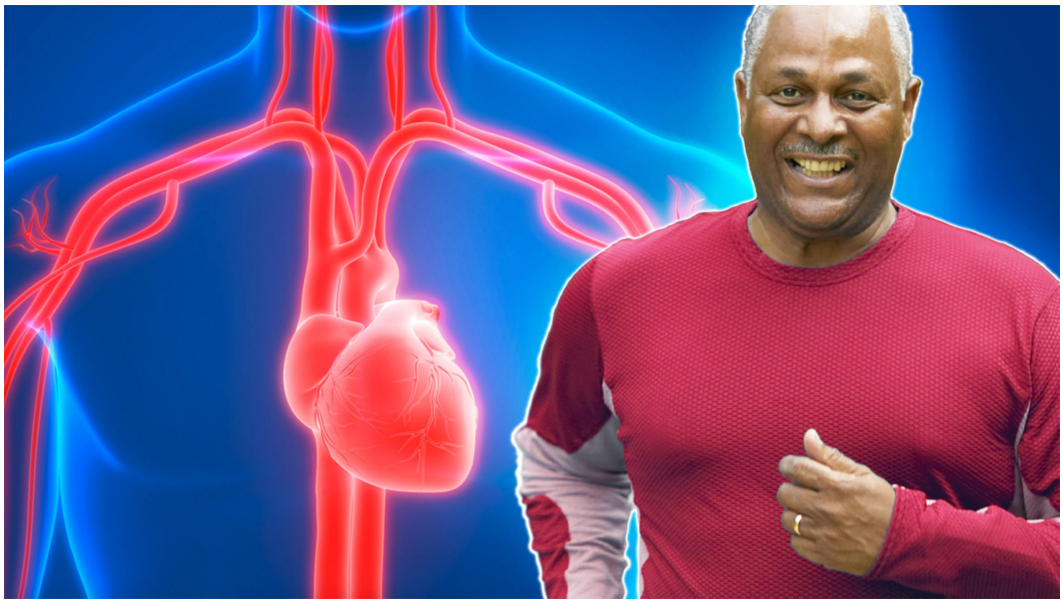
An improved troponin testing device
Currently, detection of troponin requires bulky instruments available only in a well-equipped hospital. But a South Korean team has recently developed a thermometer-like device that could make determining heart damage almost as easy as taking someone's temperature. It tests a drop of a person's blood using nanoparticles sensitized to troponin antibodies. Years of testing lie ahead, however, before this will be available.

A screening tool

Cleveland Clinic researchers have found that a by-product of intestinal bacteria can increase a person's chances of having a heart attack. The chemical by-product, called trimethylamine N-oxide (TMAO), can be detected in blood and accurately predicts a person's risk for future cardiac events such as a heart attack or stroke. More testing is needed before screening for TMAO becomes a routine part of care.
What to expect in the hospital

When a heart attack is confirmed, patients usually undergo balloon angioplasty to open up the blocked artery and restore blood flow to the heart. The doctor threads a catheter, with a small inflatable balloon on the tip, through an artery near your groin or wrist and then to the site of the blockage. Next, the balloon is inflated, compressing the plaque against the artery wall to allow blood to flow. Typically, a tube of stainless steel mesh, called a stent, is then inserted into the artery to prop it open.

After the procedure and a day or more to recuperate, you'll leave the hospital with follow-up instructions and prescriptions to help reduce the chances of a second heart attack. You should also be referred for cardiac rehabilitation, a supervised program that includes physical activity, social support and education to encourage healthful behaviors.



COMMUNITY BULLETIN

ELDER CARE

If you are a senior looking for assistance with grocery shopping, caregiving, need a ride to appointments, errands, picking up medications, run to the post office, light housekeeping or other tasks, please contact Michael at 510-604-5646. I live in Mission Bay.

NEED A PET SITTER?



Pet Sitting in the Park
by Fazi
(510) 756-9112

Services:
Feeding, fresh water, cleaning up, playtime.
Home visits.

SENIOR SUPPORT

Care by local resident
Mission Bay

- Light Housekeeping
- Gardening Help
- Tech Support
- Transportation
- Medical Appointments
- Pets etc

Your neighbor
Alexandra
510-757-4001



NOTICE

Please contact Rube at missionbaynews@gmail.com to let me know if someone on the birthday list has moved or is no longer here so I can update our list.

HOUSE CLEANING SERVICES

I'm a resident in Mission Bay and provide house cleaning service. Vacuum, dusting, mopping. Contact Muhktar 510-695-0284



Anyone with old, torn, or faded American flag, may drop them off at 239 Santa Susana for proper disposal.

N	T	P	A	N	T	H	E	R	T	G	T	F	O
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Laughter
is the Best
Medicine



San Leandro Food Assistance for Seniors

PROGRAM	DAYS OF OPERATION	ADDRESS	PHONE NUMBER	TYPE OF FOOD/SERVICE
Davis Street Food Pantry	Monday to Friday	3081 Teagarden Street, San Leandro	510-347-4620	Pantry/Groceries
Spectrum Senior Meals	Contact for schedule	Served at San Leandro Senior Center	510-881-0302	Hot Meals
Meals on Wheels	Daily meal delivery	2235 Polvorosa Avenue, San Leandro	510-582-1263	Home-Delivered Hot Meals
Mercy Brown Bag Program	Scheduled distribution days	3431 Foothill Blvd, Oakland	510-534-8540	Supplemental Groceries
Cross Streets Community Food Pantry	By appointment	20600 John Dr, Castro Valley	510-537-2464	Pantry/Groceries
Alameda County Community Food Bank	Varies (through partner agencies)	7900 Edgewater Dr, Oakland	510-635-3663	Pantry
Alameda County Community Food Bank Mobile Pantry	Varies	Mobile Locations	510-635-3663	Mobile Pantry
San Lorenzo Family Help Center	By appointment (Mon, Fri, Sat)	20960 Corsair Blvd., Hayward	341-314-6770	Pantry/Groceries
J-Sei Japanese Meals Program	Contact for schedule	1285 66th Street, Emeryville	510-654-4000	Cultural/Japanese Meals
Center for Elders' Independence (PACE)	Contact for schedule and services	1850 Fairway Dr, San Leandro	844-319-1150	Comprehensive Senior Services
South Hayward Parish	By appointment	27287 Patrick Avenue, Hayward	510-785-3663	Pantry/Groceries
Ashland Cherryland Food Pantry	Weekly distributions	27880 Hesperian Blvd, Hayward	510-606-8676	Pantry/Groceries

Eligibility: Most programs serve seniors 60+, some require registration or income qualification.
Contact: Call centers directly or visit their websites for updated schedules.

Senior Resource Guide and Important Phone Numbers

Alameda County Adult Protective Services	1 (866) 225-5277
Alameda County Crisis Support Services (24hr)	1 (800) 309-2131
Alameda County In-Home Supportive Services	1 (510) 577-1900
Alameda County Area Agency on Aging	1 (510) 577-3530
Alzheimer's Services of the East Bay	1 (510) 644-8292
American Diabetes Association	1 (510) 654-4499
Arthritis Foundation	1 (888) 391-9389
CA Dept. of Aging	1 (800) 510-2020
California Relay for Hearing Impaired	7-1-1
California Smoker's Helpline	1 (800) 662-8887
Center for Independent Living	1 (510) 841-4776
City of San Leandro Minor Home Repair	1 (510) 625-0316 x102
Consumer Fraud Reporting	1 (415) 553-7400
Covered California Hotline	1 (800) 300-1506
Davis Street Family Resource Center	1 (510) 347-4620
DMV	1 (800) 777-0133
ECHO Housing	1 (510) 581-9380
Emergency Services (Ambulance, Fire and Police)	9-1-1
Family Caregiver Alliance	1 (800) 445-8106
Flex Rides - City of San Leandro	1 (510) 577-7985
Health Insurance Counseling & Advocacy	1 (510) 839-0393
Legal Assistance for Seniors	1 (510) 832-3040
LIFE ElderCare	1 (510) 894-0370
Medi-Cal	1 (510) 670-6000
Mercy Brown Bag Program	1 (510) 534-8540 x369
Mobilehome Assistance Center (Complaints) HCD	(800) 952-8356
Mobilehome Residency Law Protection Program HCD	(800) 952-8356
Ombudsman Program	1 (510) 638-6878
PG&E Smarter Energy Line	1 (800) 933-9555
Paratransit – East Bay Paratransit (AC Transit)	1 (510) 287-5000
San Leandro Adult School	1 (510) 667-6287
San Leandro Marina Community Center	1 (510) 577-3462
San Leandro Senior Community Center	1(510) 577-3462
Senior Legal Hotline of Northern California	1 (800) 222-1753
Social Security Administration	1 (800) 772-1213
S.O.S./Meals on Wheels	1 (510) 582-1263
Spectrum Community Services, Inc.	1 (510) 881-0300
Spectrum Lunch Reservations - San Leandro SCC	1 (510) 825-9793
Supplemental Security Income (SSI)	1 (800) 772-1213
Sutter Care at Home	1 (800) 698-1273
The Friendship Line (Institute on Aging)	1 (800) 971-0016
Traffic and Transit	5-1-1
Veterans Assistance Benefits	1 (800) 827-1000
Well Connected	1 (877) 797-7299
Well Connected en Espaňol	1 (877) 400-5867